

# I. Original Pilipino Music (OPM)

OPM refers to music composed and performed by Filipinos, reflecting the nation's cultural growth through several distinct eras:

- **Early Foundations (1950s-1960s):** Musicians blended Western styles with traditional **kundiman** (love songs). Key figures included **Sylvia La Torre** and **Pilita Corrales** ("Asia's Queen of Songs").
  - **Golden Era (1970s):** Defined by the **Manila Sound**, a fusion of Filipino themes with pop, funk, and disco. Iconic groups included **Hotdog**, **VST & Company**, and **APO Hiking Society**.
  - **Rock Movement (1980s-1990s):** Rock became a voice for youth rebellion and social awareness. Notable bands included **The Dawn**, **Eraserheads** ("The Beatles of the Philippines"), **Parokya ni Edgar**, and **Rivermaya**.
  - **Pop Ballad Boom (1990s-2000s):** Focused on emotional power ballads. This era was defined by **Regine Velasquez** ("Asia's Songbird") and **Sarah Geronimo** ("Popstar Royalty").
  - **Revival and Indie Rise (2000s-2010s):** Characterized by acoustic revivals and experimental indie sounds from acts like **MYMP** and **Up Dharma Down (UDD)**.
  - **Global and OPM Wave (2010s-Present):** OPM reached the international stage. Notable acts include **SB19** (Billboard nominees), **BINI** (first P-pop act at Coachella 2026), and **Ben&Ben**.
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## II. Filipino Food and Global Influence

Filipino cuisine is a blend of Malay, Chinese, Spanish, American, and Indigenous influences, emphasizing community.

- **Media Representation:** Food is central to Filipino *teleseryes* and specialized cooking shows like *Pinas Sarap* and *Farm to Table*.

- **Global Recognition:** **Jollibee** has expanded worldwide with favorites like Chickenjoy. Innovative collaborations, such as **Abi Marquez's** "Beef Wellington Lumpia" with Gordon Ramsay, and Netflix features like *Street Food: Asia* (Cebu) highlight local flavors globally.
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### III. Evolution of Filipino Fashion

Fashion in the Philippines reflects a dynamic history of tradition and colonial influence:

- **Pre-Colonial & Spanish Era:** Transitioned from **bahag** and **baro** to the **Maria Clara gown** (formal baro't saya) and **camisa de chino**.
  - **American & Post-War Era:** Western suits and school uniforms became common, and the **Barong Tagalog** was formalized. Actresses like Carmen Rosales popularized elegant full skirts.
  - **Modern Trends (1970s-Present):**
    - **1970s-80s:** Disco styles (bell-bottoms) and "Bagets" casual teen fashion.
    - **1990s-2000s:** Streetwear influenced by **Francis Magalona** and colorful **Y2K** styles set by **Jolina Magdangal**.
    - **Current:** Adaptation of traditional textiles (**Inabel**, **T'nalak**) into modern, genderless, and K-pop-inspired designs.
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### IV. Subcultures and SOGIESC Advocacy

#### Oppositional Subcultures and Commodification

- **Subcultures:** Groups that challenge mainstream norms. Rap and rock artists (e.g., **Gloc-9**, **Bamboo**) use music and streetwear to protest social injustice.
- **Commodification:** The process of turning cultural art or resistance into marketable products. While this helps reach wider audiences, it can prioritize profit over the original social activism.

## **SOGIESC (Sexual Orientation, Gender Identity and Expression, and Sex Characteristics)**

This inclusive framework acknowledges diverse identities:

- **Sexual Orientation (SO):** To whom you are attracted.
- **Gender Identity (GI):** How you see yourself internally.
- **Gender Expression (GE):** How you present yourself (clothing, behavior).
- **Sex Characteristics (SC):** Physical features (genitalia, chromosomes).

**Advocacy:** Artists like **Ice Seguerra** and **Jake Zyrus** promote LGBTQIA+ visibility. Media like *Drag Race Philippines* and *Drag Den* present drag as a powerful form of artistic and gender expression.